

Since ancient times, the state has been identified with administration of land and agriculture because the majority of the population depended on farming. For the state, **agricultural land and farmers were of utmost importance**. This is why the British, through the **East India Company**, established the **Board of Revenue** as an effective administrative institution to strengthen the foundations of their rule in India, a model that was followed in one form or another by all the princely states.

The condition of farmers and land revenue in princely states before independence

- In **Rajputana**, the rulers of the princely states, while remaining under British authority, exercised **supreme civil and original jurisdiction within their own territories**. The people held them in high regard, but this system was **not bound by any codified law**. The rulers had **delegated the rights of revenue collection** to the elite landowning classes such as **jagirdars, biswedars, and zamindars**. About **60% of the land of the princely states** was under the control of these elites, who **collected arbitrary rents from tenant farmers** and passed on only a small portion to the ruler. There were **many intermediaries between the ruler and the cultivator**, and since the princely states had **no proper land revenue or tenancy laws**, they imposed **arbitrary taxes and dues** and **extensively exploited tenant farmers**. In effect, the **land revenue administration of the princely states depended entirely on feudal lords, jagirdars, and elite landowners**.
- In princely states such as **Mewar, Marwar, and Jaipur**, most of the land had become **jagirs** of landlords and ministers. Although the **total income of all princely states was about £23.50 lakh**, of which **£15 lakh came from land revenue**, **no serious efforts were made to improve the condition of farmers**.

First efforts to improve the condition of farmers

- In **1927**, at the session of the **Rajputana Princely States People's Council** held in **Bombay**, the **Praja Mandal Movement** was initiated for the first time. As a result, **exploited farmers and the common people** were attracted towards this movement. In **1938**, at the **Haripura Session** of the Indian National Congress (presided over by **Subhas Chandra Bose**), the **Praja Mandal Movement** was given **moral support**, and a demand was raised for **responsible government in the princely states**.
- Initially, the rulers and feudal lords of all the princely states **strongly opposed the Praja Mandal Movement**. However, due to pressure from the **general public**, who were suffering from the **exploitation and oppression by feudal lords and jagirdars**, the princely states were forced to show **some softening in their authoritarian attitude**.
- The **unity and strength of the Indian National Congress and the people of the princely states (farmers)** became so strong that the **rulers of the princely states had no political option left other than to join the Indian Union**.

The beginning of the Revenue Boards in the princely states

- The princely states, under British influence, began to pay more attention to **land administration** and started **reorganizing their revenue departments**. **Bikaner** established its **Board of Revenue in 1909**, and **Jaipur** followed in **1942**. Similarly, **Jodhpur, Matsya Union, former Rajasthan Union, and smaller states like Bundi** also had their own **Revenue Boards**.
- The **Boards of Revenue of Bikaner and Jaipur** were responsible not only for **land revenue**, but also for **customs duties, excise, livestock, stamp and registration matters**.
 1. **Bikaner Board of Revenue**: Recommended appointments of **Tehsildars and Naib-Tehsildars to the Maharaja**, and handled matters such as **revenue assessment, land transfer, ejection, and revenue collection**.
 2. **Jaipur Board of Revenue**: Served as the **final appellate revenue court for all revenue matters in the state**.

Formation of the Integrated Revenue Board after Independence

- ❖ During the **integration of the princely states into the Indian Union**, as farmers began to receive **legal rights**, the **jagirdars, biswedars, and zamindars** started committing **atrocities and illegal ejections** against them. This led to **conflicts between landowners and farmers** and disrupted law and order.
- ❖ To **protect the farmers**, the then **Rajpramukh, Maharaja Sawai Man Singh II**, issued a **special ordinance**:
 - **Rajasthan (Protection of Farmers) Ordinance, 1949 [21 June 1949]**

Establishment of the Revenue Board

- The **Revenue Boards of Bikaner, Jaipur, Jodhpur, Matsya Union, and the former Rajasthan Union** were **merged to form a unified Revenue Board for the entire state of Rajasthan** by the then **Rajpramukh, Maharaja Sawai Man Singh II**, through an ordinance.
- **Revenue Board Ordinance, 1949 – issued on 7 April 1949.**
- **Formation of the Revenue Board – 1 November 1949**
- **Objective**: The **Integrated Revenue Board** was established to provide **cheap, speedy, and accessible justice** to poor farmers caught in **land revenue disputes**, without involving them in unnecessary complications.
- Thus, the newly formed **Revenue Board** became the **highest appellate revenue court for the entire state of Rajasthan**, handling **appeals, revisions, references, and other revenue matters**. Under its **dual functions**, it was also entrusted with **land record administration and other judicial revenue-related tasks**.
- The **Provisions of Revenue Board** is in **Chapter-2 (Sections 4 to 14) of Land Revenue Act, 1956 [Implemented on 1 July 1956]**

Provisions related to the Revenue Board [Chapter 2 (Sections 4 to 14)]

Establishment and Composition of the Revenue Board [Section-4]	➤ Formation: 1 November 1949 ➤ Headquarters – Ajmer ➤ Structure: 1 Chairman + 20 other members (minimum 3 members mandatory) ➤ Appointment: By the State Government (published in the Gazette) ➤ Service Conditions: Determined by the State Government ➤ Functions: To hear appeals, revisions, references, and reviews in revenue matters (acts as the highest appellate court in revenue disputes)
Tenure of Members [Section-5]	They hold office during the pleasure of the Governor.
Place of Sitting [Section-6]	Ajmer
Ministerial Staff and Other Officers [Section-7]	One Registrar and Other Officers (appointed by the State Government)
Powers of the Revenue Board [Section-8]	➤ It is the highest revenue court for the entire state of Rajasthan, handling appeals, revisions, references, and reviews under the provisions of the Land Revenue Act, Rajasthan Tenancy Act, and other revenue laws. ✎ In cases of disputes between the Revenue Court and Civil Court concerning any territorial officer, the decision of the High Court shall be final and binding.
Supervision and Control by the Revenue Board [Section-9]	The supervision and control of all subordinate revenue courts in Rajasthan shall be exercised by the Revenue Board.
Exercise of Authority by the Revenue Board [Section-10]	➤ The jurisdiction of the Revenue Board extends over the entire state of Rajasthan. ➤ The Revenue Board exercises its authority through a single bench, divisional bench, and full bench. ✎ An appeal against the decision of a single bench can be filed before the divisional bench within one month.
Power to refer to a Bench [Section-11]	The Revenue Board may refer a case from the single bench to the divisional bench or full bench with written reasons if the case involves a question of law or custom.
Power to Refer Questions to the High Court [Section-12]	The Revenue Board may refer any case from a bench to the High Court with written reasons if the case involves a question of public importance that requires the opinion of the High Court.
Decision in case of difference of opinion [Section-13]	In case of a difference of opinion within a bench of the Revenue Board, the decision is made based on the majority.

Registers and Records to be Maintained in the Revenue Board [Section-14]

The Revenue Board maintains various registers, books, and accounting documents (a total of 60 registers) in the course of performing its functions.

- ✎ **Other functions of the Revenue Board:** Appointment, transfer, training, promotion, and disciplinary actions of revenue personnel (from Patwari to Tehsildar level) throughout the state of Rajasthan.

Organizational Structure

1 Chairman + (3–20 Members) + 1 Registrar + 2 Additional Registrar + 3 Deputy Registrar + 1 Joint Director

Chairman	Senior IAS officer (Current Chairman – Shri Hemant Gera)
Other Members	Officers from administrative and judicial backgrounds related to land matters
1 Registrar	Manages all administrative functions of the Revenue Board (Current Registrar – Shri Mahavir Prasad)

Members

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|---------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------------|
| 1. Shri Tikam Chand Bohra | 2. Shri Kishor Kumar | 3. Shri Kesar Lal Meena |
| 4. Shri Suresh Chandra | 5. Shri Ajit Singh Rajawat | 6. Dr. Shiv Prasad Singh |
| 7. Shri Rajesh Singh | 8. Shri Madan Lal Nehra | 9. Shri Bhawani Singh Palawat |
| 10. Dr. Mahendra Lodha | 11. Shri Gaurav Bajad | 12. Shri Rajendra Singh Kaviya |

- ✎ **Ravira:** The Revenue Board publishes a quarterly magazine under the name *Ravira*.
- ✎ **Digital Display** – Judicial Case Digital Display System (touch screen for information related to any case in the premises of the Board of Revenue)
- ✎ **GCMS** – Generalized Court Management System (for information on the current status of revenue cases)
- ✎ **DILRMP** – Digital India Land Record Modernization Program

Subordinate Revenue Courts:

The following courts function under the Board of Revenue: –

1. Divisional Commissioner
2. District Collector
3. Additional District Collector (ADM)
4. Revenue Appellate Authority (RAA)
5. Land Management ex officio Revenue Appellate Authority
6. Sub-Divisional Officer (SDO)
7. Assistant Collector & Executive Magistrate (ACEM)
8. Tehsildar (TDR)

Sections of the Board of Revenue:

In the Board of Revenue, apart from judicial functions, separate sections are functioning for administrative work, as follows:

1. Administration Branch
2. RTS Branch
3. Land Records Branch
4. Accounts Branch
5. Inspection Branch
6. Departmental Inquiry Branch
7. Writ Branch
8. Statistics Branch
9. Store Branch
10. Archives Branch
11. Bill Branch
12. Library Branch
13. Computer Branch
14. Cash Branch
15. RAVIRA Branch

Important Sections

Sections	Provisions	Sections	Provisions
Section 4	Establishment and Composition of the Revenue Board	Section 10	Exercise of authority by the Revenue Board
Section 5	Term of office of members	Section 11	Power to refer to a bench
Section 6	Place of Sitting	Section 12	Power to refer questions to the High Court
Section 7	Ministerial staff and other officers	Section 13	Decision in case of differences of opinion
Section 8	Powers of the Revenue Board	Section 14	Registers and records maintained by the Revenue Board
Section 9	Supervision and control by the Revenue Board	—	—
